

Jay Ballesteros-Cobián

MPP student at The University of Chicago

Chicago, IL

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Education

Master of Public Policy (MPP), Candidate

Chicago, IL

University of Chicago, Harris School of Public Policy

Sep. 2025 – Present

- Fellow at the Existential Risk Laboratory (xLab); completed workshops in AI Safety, Transformative Economics, and AI Policy
- Currently pursuing Finance & Policy, Energy & Environmental Policy and Data Analytics specializations
- Relevant coursework explores Causal Inference, Program Evaluation, Machine Learning for Public Policy, Microeconomics, Conflict and Applied Data Science, Corporate Finance, Impact Investing, among others
- Applied coursework using Python and R for data analysis, visualization, and experimental design

B.A. International Relations

Colima, México

Universidad de Colima

Aug. 2012 – Jun. 2016

- Emphasis on the Asia-Pacific region and international security
- Erasmus Mundus exchange at Universidad de León (Spain), coursework in finance and international trade

Experience

Senior Operations Analyst – Mature Cities

Mexico City

DiDi Global Inc.

Apr. 2025 – Nov. 2025

- Directed marketplace operations across three Mexican cities, overseeing a combined annual GMV of MXN 3.7B and a weekly incentives portfolio averaging MXN 4M
- Created and executed randomized and quasi-experimental tests (A/B testing) to evaluate supply-demand balancing tactics on trips, fulfillment rates, user satisfaction, and other KPIs
- Built performance dashboards and automated reporting pipelines using Python, SQL, and Looker Studio; produced weekly analytical briefs for senior leadership with experiment results and action plans
- Partnered with regional and central teams (pricing, marketing, strategy, CX) to scale successful pilots and adapt evidence-based practices across markets

Co-founder and Data Analyst

Mexico City

Datahué

Aug. 2023 – Present

- Designed and implemented a MEAL strategy for Fundación Amparo, including 60+ performance indicators to track program outcomes and inform decision-making
- Consolidated 100+ databases into a centralized repository using Python, Google Apps Script, SQL, and Looker Studio; led a three-person team for data collection, cleaning, and evidence-based reporting to executive directors

Strategy Analyst

Mexico City

Soy+ (soymas.la)

Mar. 2025 – Apr. 2025

- Built automated dashboards connected via APIs to real-time databases; unified Mailchimp, Meta API, Supabase, and Vercel data into structured datasets for campaign evaluation and user segmentation

Senior Analyst

Mexico City

C230 Consulting and Fundación IDEA

Jan. 2021 – Mar. 2025

- Delivered eight projects in security/justice reform, M&E, interinstitutional coordination, process optimization, market analysis and development for government counterparts and international organizations including the U.S. Department of State, USAID–Chemonics, and SANOFI
- Designed and executed an impact evaluation of the Impulso Nuevo León Loan Guarantee Program, analyzing changes in beneficiaries' sales and employment to assess program effectiveness on firm performance
- Created data-collection instruments for 80+ private-sector stakeholders in Honduras and El Salvador to inform the AMEXCID Jovenes Construyendo el Futuro program, supporting evidence generation for youth workforce policy

- Conducted a mixed-methods study on quality of life with Atopic Dermatitis for SANOFI, combining interviews, surveys, and quantitative analysis for evidence-based recommendations to national health institutions
- Developed institutional-strengthening toolkits for State Attorney General Offices; built measurement frameworks for recidivism monitoring in civic and criminal justice systems across multiple municipalities
- Advised on best practices in agriculture, youth workforce development, and migration across El Salvador, Honduras, Guatemala, and Mexico, identifying enabling conditions for replicable development initiatives

Founder and Data Analyst

Colima, Mexico

DataCol

May 2020 – Jul. 2021

- Led a government-funded analytics initiative for real-time COVID-19 monitoring, building time-series visualizations for the State Secretary of Health used in cabinet briefings; analyzed Google mobility datasets using Python to inform public health strategies

Consultant

Mexico City

International Republican Institute

Aug. 2018 – Jul. 2021

- Coordinated the Security with Justice Program in five Mexican states, engaging government counterparts, civil society, academia, and the private sector to promote ADR mechanisms; facilitated 30+ workshops training 1,100+ participants
- Managed MEL indicators in DevResults and Tableau; collected, analyzed, and reported open data on alternative justice across 15 states, identifying best practices for institutional strengthening

Competitiveness Manager

Colima, México

Coparmex

Jun. 2016 – Aug. 2018

- Directed capacity-building programs on business administration, productivity, and labor rights; produced research on security, justice, and economic trends for private-sector stakeholders

Key Skills and Competencies

Methods

Causal inference and impact evaluation (diff-in-diff, RCTs, pre-post designs), experimental design (A/B testing), MEAL frameworks, mixed-methods research

Tools

Python, R, SQL, Excel, Looker Studio, Power BI, Tableau, Quarto; dashboards, automation, and data engineering (APIs, pipelines); AI-assisted development tools (Claude Code, Copilot, Codex)

Languages

Spanish (native), English (professional fluency, IELTS 8.0)